

1. Explain how Jensen's (2021) category of "digital archival literacy" addresses the distinct challenges digital archives represent for historical research. How has digitization changed historians' interactions with their sources? In your response, focus on two points that you found most thought-provoking. You may also choose to cite Jensen and Schriver (2022) in your response.

In her article from 2020¹, Jensen argues that, because sources are being digitized, historians are beginning to face new kinds of problems and opportunities. She, for example, argues that the way that the digital archives are displayed and organized influences the way one that you view sources and which sources that you find. For example, if you wanted to research a topic, before the digital archives, you would go down to the library and find the information in traditional sources. While you were doing that you would encounter metadata. With other words you get a bunch of "data" that is related to the sources witch you then must distinguish between. That is not the case with digital archives. When you look up sources you don't automatically (at least in the same way) get a bunch of related data that you as an historian must make up one's mind about. For example, the archive can be founded by an organization or project that have particular interest or agendas (for example that it should speak to a broad audience or a certain topic). This influence which sources that are chosen to be preserved and digitized. And thus, influencing what kind of data that we as historians are presented. Jensen there for argues that it is important as historians to think about what data therefor was omitted² and why it was omitted, since these kinds of meta data often can lead to perspectives on the subject or play a role in the creditability of the digital source.

2. Briefly provide the biographical details of the interviewee.

I choose the interview with Baruch Friedman³, done by Davide Boder the 2 of September 1946

The one being interviewed is Baruch Friedman, a Slovakian Zionist that did not believe in the official story about Jews being relocated into workcamps and therefor hid in a forest with his younger brother with the help of a gentile acquaintance. Eventually when the deportation had stopped the brothers reported voluntarily to one of the Slovekian workcamps (which was relatively

¹ Helle Jensen, "Helle Strandgaard Jensen", i *Media History* (2020, 2020), <https://doi.org/10.1080/13688804.2020.1779047>.

² Jensen, "Helle Strandgaard Jensen", 6.

³ Baruch Friedman, "David P. Boder Interviews Baruch Friedman", (Tradate Italien), Illinois institute of Technology, 2. september 1946, Lydoptagelse, Voices of The Holocaust, [https://iit.aviaryplatform.com/collections/231/collection_resources/17610?u=t&keywords\[\]=Baruch&keywords\[\]=Friedman](https://iit.aviaryplatform.com/collections/231/collection_resources/17610?u=t&keywords[]=Baruch&keywords[]=Friedman).

agreeable). Freedmen and his younger brother were freed along with other Jews when the uprising against Tiso's regime happened in August 28 - October 2, 1944. After having been freed both Friedman fought in the uprising (but Friedman did have his reservations with both the anti-Nazi Slovaks and the uprisings chances for success). At the time that Friedman was interviewed he was living with his brother in Italy.

3. After reading the "description" panel, discuss the provenance of the source. For example, what metadata is provided by the archive, and which historical details did the archive choose to emphasize in their written summary of the recording?

The first thing that I noticed when I was analyzing the provenance of Baruch Friedman's story was that the Illinois Institute of Technology/David Boder had chosen to record and tag which subjects the recording fitted under. Which was, for example: "World War, 1939-1945--Refugees". This is interesting because it tells us what aspects of the interviews that Boder used to categorize and order the interviews in and there what aspects of the interview that he found important. The same can be said with the beforehand described summary of the interview. Here we can see that Boder thought that it was important to record how and why Friedman ended up in a work camp and what happened with him and his brother after that they had been freed. It is also evident that Boder found it relevant (and yet another way of organizing/categorizing the interviews) to record what city Friedmann had come from, since "Kurima (Slovakia)" also is a tag given to the interview. Next, Boder/ the Illinois Institute of Technology chose to record the different people that had a relation to the interview (for example, that the interviewee was Baruch Friedmann and the interviewer: David P. Boder). This is interesting because it shows an interest in the interview's different participants (and later handlers), which gives us an idea of the amount of handling/interpretation (and there with its level of credibility) the interview has gone through before being archived. Lastly, the archive chose to include that Friedmann's story have the source-types of "interview" and "oral history".

4. What are the implications of using interview recordings as a historical source?

The implications of interview recording as a historical source is that we as listeners must interpret what is being communicated. This does maybe not sound as much but as opposed to written historical sources (where the writer writes his intentions/feelings plainly) the sound recordings of interviews requires that the listeners to interpret themselves what are being said and how it is being said (is the

interviewee sad, happy or something third?). This means that an element of ambiguity gets introduced which we, as historians, not always are interested in since it leads to confusion and strife since to different people can have slightly different interpretation of the recorded interview. That said, it is also a benefit of record interviews as historical sources that we get a feeling of the situation that the interview was conducted, which we could not get by reading a traditional source. One of the other implications interview recordings have been that an interview is limited in the information's it gives by the questions that are asked by the interviewer. Therefore the interview (and there for the sources itself) is formed by the desires, curiosities and ideas of importance the interviewer may have and not what the interviewee could have found important. Lastly, it is also worth mentioning that the interview recording themselves does not provide any tags or keyword which means that they are difficult to find when searching the digital archives, which then limits the availability of the source. That also means that these tags and keyword, must be provided by translates/transcribes which themselves interprets the source and by doing so influences the general understanding of source.

5. Compare and contrast the use of digitized historical sources in web-based databases with reborn digital sources in the archived Web. Should these sources be treated differently when conducting historical research? To complete this task, draw on your knowledge of at least two database collections discussed in class and/or your readings. In your response, please support your position using relevant literature from our course, such as Kelley (2019), Johnson (2018), Brügger (2019), and the articles mentioned in part one of this assignment.

I think that both types of historical sources are useful for us as historians. This I think because it is my experience that digitized historical sources (for example the documents that the royal Danish library has been/are digitizing, as pictures on their website) and the reborn digital sources with (for example the "wayback machine" which we were introduced in class) can tell us different things about a chosen topic. That said, these kinds of digital sources are not in any way infallible.

First, it is important, when working with digital sources to consider how the different sources were made. As Brügger⁴ mentions in her article from 2019, the reborn digital sources are made by scanning a given website, with no certainty that when the website did not change while or after the program had finish copying the website. This is important to consider because it makes it, so the reborn digital sources are made of fragments. This means that the reborn websites that find in the archived web is made up of different pieces that were not necessarily made (and thus not displayed) at the same time. This is important to consider if your goal is to use the reborn digital archive to illuminate a specific time/date, because you can't be sure that the portrayal of the web site that you are presented by the web archive are the exactly the same as you would have meet if you had visited the website within the relevant period.

This is a problem that the digitized historical sources do not have. Because the digitized historical source of is a picture or a screenshot that a program or person at some times have taken (and thus not an attempt to copy of the source) the contend of the archived material does not have the risk of having been stich together using chronological-different pieces.

The real difference between these two kinds of sources is the amount and way we as research can interact with the past. What is mean by this is that, when you access a former version of a chosen website though a web archive, you get to interact with the website as if you used it while it was the current version. You get to click on the website's different hyperlinks, to see what kind of material/topics that the web site made references to and so on (all though It should be said that because different websites are archived at different times, you run the risk that the websites that are referenced on your initial archived website, are from a much later or earlier time). You get an opportunity to get a feeling of how the website was perceived by its users. This is not the case with digitized historical sources. Because digitized historical sources often consist of a picture, you, as a historian/user of the digital archive, only get to do you analysis on the written content of that source. This mean that you don't get the same feeling of what context/situation the source was created. With other words you don't get the same amount of meta data.

Lastly, I will just note that one of the other biggest differences between reborn- and digitized historical sources is that reborn digital often are archival multiball times and thus allows the user to see the progression of the archived website, while the digitized source often only are digitized once

⁴ Niels Brügger, "DIGITAL HISTORIE OG ARKIVERET WEB SOM HISTORISK KILDE", *DIGITAL HISTORIE OG ARKIVERET WEB SOM HISTORISK KILDE*, 2019.

(this is because the original source behind the digitized version does not change its martial, like websites does)

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